▼ GLASSHOUSE



FLIPPED SCRIPT

In Telangana and Andhra Pradesh, where film stars are revered as demigods, politicians rarely risk prolonged friction. Telangana chief minister **Revanth Reddy** had once called 'Icon Star' **Allu Arjun**'s conduct "inhumane" after a stampede at the premiere of *Pushpa 2* in Hyderabad left a woman dead and her young son critically injured. Arjun was arrested and spent a night in jail, triggering a backlash from fans and even Opposition leaders. Six months on, there was a twist in the plot. Reddy handed Arjun the Best Actor award for the same film at the inaugural state-backed Gaddar Film Awards. And now he's also inaugurated the actor's family-owned Allu Cinemas, hailing him as a star destined for Hollywood. "*Thaggede-le*"—Arjun can now repeat his famous "won't back down" dialogue from *Pushpa*.

Illustrations by **SIDDHANT JUMDE**

▼ WHO'S NEXT IN BIHAR

MIXED SIGNALS

With Bihar CM **Nitish Kumar** set to step down and the field wide open on a possible successor, even minute signals are being analysed to death. During the recent Samriddhi Yatra, Nitish put his hand on BJP leader and deputy CM **Samrat Choudhary**'s shoulder saying: "He will handle everything now." Enough for a whisper campaign suggesting that Nitish had given his blessings. But then, on March 19, the other deputy CM, **Vijay Sinha**, received a similar pat on the back at a meeting in Lakhisarai. Which is when the script started blurring. And then someone remembered that Nitish had done this with another ex-deputy, RJD chief Tejashwi Yadav, and everyone knows how that ended.

